

Industry News

In Focus

In five years, 62 per cent cars to use consumer telematics

The percentage of new passenger cars globally shipping with factory-installed telematics will increase from less than 10 per cent in 2010 to 62 per cent in 2016.

"Several factors are driving the uptake of OEM telematics, the most important being an automotive industry that is emerging from a painful recession and finding renewed dynamism," says ABI Research practice director Dominique Bonte.

At the same time, soaring interest in adoption of open platforms and integration of smartphones and telematics applications into vehicles represents nothing less than a renaissance of both the consumer and commercial telematics markets. Initiatives such as the Open Source GENIVI infotainment platform and Nokia's Terminal Mode standard are creating high expectations and resulting in industry-wide cooperation.

Global IT spending will grow 5.1 per cent this year

Worldwide IT spending is forecast to total \$3.6 trillion in 2011—a 5.1 per cent increase from 2010—according to market research firm Gartner. In 2010, worldwide IT spending totalled \$3.4 trillion—up 5.4 per cent from 2009 levels.

The telecom equipment market is poised for the strongest growth, with worldwide telecom equipment spending forecast to grow 9.1 per cent. Strong sales of mobile devices in the third quarter of 2010 (driven by smartphones in mature markets and white box devices in emerging markets) as well as stronger local currencies resulted in an upward revision of Gartner's forecast. The computing hardware segment is forecast to grow 7.5 per cent, but vendors face possible challenges, particu-

AMD CEO resigns

AMD's chief executive Dirk Meyer has been asked to leave as the company plans to grow aggressively in the next coming years. Chief financial officer Thomas Seifert has been appointed as the interim-CEO, although he has expressed little interest in being permanently considered for this position.

Meyer came at a time when the company was in a serious condition and needed stability in its functioning. He took over from previous CEO Hector Ruiz under whose leadership a technical glitch forced the unavailability of a key product from the company.

Choudhury, SEMI India's new president

SEMI, the global industry association serving the manufacturing supply chains for the microelectronics, display and photovoltaic industries, has appointed Debasish Paul Choudhury as the new president for its India operations. Choudhury will succeed Sathya Prasad, who has led SEMI India since its inception. Prasad will continue to participate in an advisory role through the transition.

Former Microsoft MD joins Google

Google has appointed Rajan Anandan, the former MD of Microsoft, as the vice president (sales and operations) and head of India region. Earlier, at Microsoft India, Anandan was responsible for all facets of Microsoft's software and services business in India.

Tata reshuffles management in telecom units

Tata Sons has announced two major changes at the top management of its telecom companies Tata Communications and Tata Teleservices. Replacing N. Srinath, Tata Communications has elevated Vinod Kumar, director, as the new managing director and chief executive officer of the company. Srinath has now been appointed as the MD and CEO of Tata Teleservices (TTSL) and Tata Teleservices (Maharashtra).

LG's Manikandan joins HP

R. Manikandan, LG Electronics India's business head for business solutions, has left LG to join the IPG group of Hewlett Packard (HP) India. He has been appointed as the director for inkjet web solutions at HP India.

Manikandan had been associated with LG for quite a long time. Prior to LG, he headed sales at Acer Communications & Multimedia.

Good Will appoints marketing manager in India

Following the decision to set up its own presence in India, Taiwan-based Good Will Instrument, a global test and measurement instruments manufacturer, has appointed Sumit Sharma as marketing manager for India. Sharma, Good Will's first resident employee in India, is based in Noida and responsible for sales and marketing operations across India.

larly in PC growth, given the likely weak economic growth through the first half of 2011.

Sales of computers and mobiles to decline

An Accenture survey predicts the consumer purchases of personal computers and mobile phones (excluding smartphones) this year to decline by 39 per cent and 56 per cent, respectively, compared to

